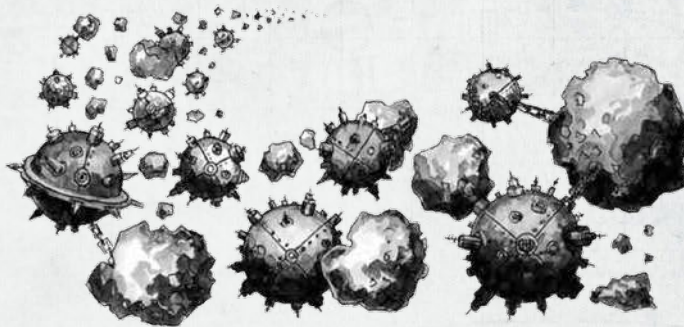


**SPECIAL**

- A minefield covers an area that is $D3 \times 5$ cm by $D3 \times 5$ cm and must be placed with an edge within 15 cm of a tabletop feature (such as a planet, moon or asteroid field).
- A minefield will block line of sight through it. Toward friendly ships, a minefield behaves as an asteroid field in all respects, and they may traverse a minefield as they would an asteroid field normally. Foolhardy enemy vessels may attempt to do so using a leadership check as when traversing an asteroid field.
- In the owning players ordnance phase, roll a dice for each enemy ship within 30 cm of the edge of the minefield. On a roll of a 5 or 6 the ship has been detected. Add +1 to the roll if the ship is on *All Ahead Full* orders and deduct -1 if it is on *Burn Retros* orders, also subtract -1 if the ship is an Escort. For each ship detected, the player may place one orbital mine anywhere in contact with the edge of the minefield. Once in play, orbital mines follow the rules on pg. 492. Enemy ships inside a minefield will affect activating mines just as if they were outside the minefield normally, in which case they would be the first ship(s) targeted by any activated mines. If multiple enemy vessels enter a minefield and activate mines, the player owning the minefield determines which vessels activated mines attack first.
- Attack craft are not large enough to activate mines and can hide in a minefield the same way they may do so in an asteroid field (destroyed on a D6 roll of 6).
- Torpedoes that contact a minefield are destroyed.
- It is possible to suppress a minefield with firing, using gun decks and lances to create a swirl of gas and debris to blind the field's motion trackers. When shooting at minefields, treat them as ordnance for purposes of target priority. A minefield may be fired at like an Ordnance marker and has an armour value of 6. Each hit scored allows you to place one Blast marker in contact with the minefield. If a minefield has Blast markers in contact with it, deduct -1 from any dice rolls to detect ships. In each end phase, each minefield will lose D6 Blast markers and these do not count towards the number of other Blast markers that can be removed that turn.
- Individual mines deployed from a minefield do not normally count for victory points when destroyed.

As well as solitary mines, some systems are protected by minefields covering several thousand kilometres. If an enemy approaches too close, the motion-tracking surveyors may detect the intruder and activate several of the mines to seek out the target and detonate.